
Recitation 1: Markdown

Icebreaker

Expectations

- recitation attendance is MANDATORY
- graded based on participation in activity - add your name to a team's slide
- not about learning specific material or hearing more lectures - recitations are for design thinking and open discussion

Markdown

What is it?

A **simple markup language** that allows you to customize text with italics, bold text, numbered lists, images, links, etc. *without needing HTML* (however, you can still use HTML if you want to format something in a way that is not explicitly supported in Markdown)

Resources

<https://www.markdownguide.org/cheat-sheet/>
<https://61040.github.io/fa26/resources/>

Element	Markdown Syntax
Heading	# H1 ## H2 ### H3
Bold	**bold text**
Italic	<i>*italicized text*</i>
Blockquote	> blockquote
Ordered List	1. First item 2. Second item 3. Third item
Unordered List	- First item - Second item - Third item
Code	`code`
Horizontal Rule	---
Link	[title](https://www.example.com)
Image	![alt text](image.jpg)

Why Markdown?

It's portable and platform-independent!

Unlike specialized applications like Microsoft Word and their file types, Markdown can be **edited and viewed in many different applications**.

Markdown is used **nearly everywhere** (e.g., Reddit, GitHub) and, given that near-universal support, can be used for a **variety of tasks**, like formatting a website or taking notes.

Limitations

Expressivity

Can only format your text in **ways that are natively supported** by Markdown (i.e., no CSS-type equivalent for defining your own styles) and **does not allow for advanced features** by not integrating with JavaScript

No “Official Specification”

While this allows for tailoring Markdown to specific usages through different “flavors”, it leads to **inconsistent renderings and formatting across implementations**

Markdown as conceptual inventions

Emphasizing

Bad situation: Can't differentiate importance

Invention: Explicit emphasis markers

weak emphasis ****strong emphasis****

Referencing

Bad situation: Can't refer to other material

Invention: Name/reference separation

[Name of thing](link/to/thing.md)

Structuring

Bad situation: Can't discern parts and their relations

Invention: Nested heading structure

Heading 1 **### Heading 3**

Other concepts...?

Instructions

1. Make a COPY of slide 9.
2. Add your names at the bottom.
3. For 10 minutes, answer the prompts to design a new markup language.
4. Share insights.

Bad situation: Can't differentiate importance

Invention: Explicit emphasis markers

weak emphasis ****strong emphasis****

Name: Emphasizing

Invent your own markup language

Bad situation: Can't differentiate importance

Invention: Explicit emphasis markers

weak emphasis ****strong emphasis****

Name: Emphasizing

Bad situation:

Invention:

Name:

Bad situation:

Invention:

Name:

Notes

Reminders

- class website @ web.mit.edu/6.104
- assignment E1 due Monday 11:59pm
- [request access](#) to Commons if you're still not registered